

The Remote or Virtual Interview

Estimated time needed: 4 minutes

Introduction

Companies are looking to hire the best talent and are no longer limiting their search to the area they are based in. The search now extends across cities and states and sometimes even from across countries. In such situations, the best option might be a virtual interview instead of a face-to-face interview.

Objectives

After completing this reading, you will be able to:

- Apply tips to participate in a virtual or remote interview successfully.

Note: Many tips are appropriate for both virtual and face-to-face interviews. However, they are worth repeating.

Tips to prepare for a virtual interview

Here are some tips to help you prepare for a virtual interview.

Device, internet connectivity, and applications

- Ensure that you have a stable internet connection and a quiet environment to avoid any interruptions.
- Ensure you have the application loaded on your computer that the firm will use to conduct the interview. Popular choices are Zoom and Teams.
- Practice using the application and learn how to perform basic presentation tasks such as video, mute, sharing, and so on, prior to the interview.

Camera and microphone

- Make sure that your camera and microphone are working properly before the interview.
- Test out your system before the interview begins.
- Download any updates required on your computer prior to the interview.
- Required updates may limit or disable certain technical functions until the updates are complete.

Pre-work

- Ensure any pre-work or documentation requirements were fulfilled.
- Have documentation that may be pertinent to share during the interview open on your computer and easily accessible if the need to share develops. Examples may include your resume, a testimonial to your character, or examples of your work.

Notes

- Have a notebook, notepad, and a pen or any application to take notes during the interview.
- You may also want to have talking points available in a notebook or on index cards you can refer to during the interview.

Dress

- Dress professionally and choose a well-lit location for the interview.
- Dress as if you were attending the interview face-to-face.
- Adjust your camera settings to high definition.
- Carefully consider your background. Try to avoid any background that would distract from the focus of the interview. The primary focus should be on you.

Company culture

- Familiarize yourself with the company's culture and values to demonstrate your interest and knowledge of the organization.
- Try to find out who will conduct the interview and research their profiles on social media. Their profile will often share their position in the firm, values, and what they believe is important.
- Try to match your attributes to those of the interviewer when it makes sense.

Prepare for behavioral questions

- The HR and technical screening interviews were meant to evaluate your skills.
- A final interview will be more focused on behavioral questions. For example, Give us an overview of your leadership skills.

Punctuality

- Be punctual and log in to the virtual meeting room a few minutes before the scheduled time.
- Don't have the interviewer waiting for you.

Non-verbal communications

- Maintain eye contact and engage with the interviewer throughout the interview.
- Share a positive and upbeat tone.
- Don't be afraid to smile.

Follow-up

- Follow up with a thank-you note or email after the interview to express your gratitude and reiterate your interest in the position.
- Try to send a thank you note within 24 hours of the interview's completion.



Skills Network